

Inversions

Part 1: Proofreading quiz

Each sentence contains ONE error. Underline the error and write the full corrected sentence. Items 1–5 review relative clauses from Lesson 1; Item 6 previews today's topic — inversions.

Sentence	Correction (Teacher's version)
Social media connects people instantly which makes the world feel smaller.	Social media connects people instantly, which makes the world feel smaller. (Add a comma before the connective clause.)
Online courses are ideal for busy adults, especially those which have little time to attend classes.	Online courses are ideal for busy adults, especially those who have little time to attend classes. (People take 'who', not 'which'.)
There are dozens of messaging apps, all of them are free to use.	There are dozens of messaging apps, all of which are free to use. (A pronoun cannot join two clauses; use 'which'.)
The forum which students share their homework is very popular.	Teacher's Answer A: The forum on which students share their homework is very popular. Teacher's Answer B: The forum where students share their homework is very popular. (Add the missing preposition 'on'.)
Many teenagers spend hours gaming, that worries their parents.	Many teenagers spend hours gaming, which worries their parents. ('That' cannot begin a connective clause.)
Never the school has seen such strong demand for online lessons.	Never has the school seen such strong demand for online lessons. (Move the auxiliary before the subject — more on this today.)

Part 2: Four patterns for formal writing

All four patterns follow the same rule: the auxiliary verb (or the verb 'be') moves before the subject. Study the structure of each pattern, then see how it works inside a formal paragraph.

Pattern 1: Not only ... but also ...

Structure:	Not only + auxiliary + subject + verb, but (subject) also + verb
Use in formal writing:	Use it to add a second advantage in proposals, reports and articles.
Example:	Not only does the scheme save money, but it also builds confidence.

Introducing a school e-learning platform would bring clear benefits. *Not only does the platform give students round-the-clock access to learning materials, but it also allows teachers to track progress more closely.* With such a system, revision becomes a habit rather than a scramble before exams.

Pattern 2: Only + adverbial

Structure:	Only + when / after / by + clause or phrase + auxiliary + subject + verb
Use in formal writing:	Use it to set a condition that leads to a result — the heart of persuasive writing.
Example:	Only when students manage their screen time can they learn effectively.

Apart from teaching digital skills, schools must shape how students use them. *Only when young people learn to manage their screen time can they make the most of online learning.* Guidance, not punishment, is therefore the more effective response.

Pattern 3: Never / Rarely / Seldom

Structure:	Never / Rarely / Seldom + auxiliary + subject + verb
Use in formal writing:	Use it to turn a criticism or a surprising claim into a formal, striking opening.
Example:	Rarely do we question our daily screen habits.

Many parents blame video games for every poor result. *Rarely do they stop to consider how limited their children's other entertainment options are.* The real problem may be the lack of balance, not the games themselves.

Pattern 4: So ... that / Such ... that

Structure:	So + adjective + auxiliary + subject + verb + that ... OR Such + be + noun phrase + that ...
Use in formal writing:	Use it to open with a strong statement when emphasising the scale or importance of an issue.

Example:	Such is the influence of social media that it shapes public opinion overnight.
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The smartphone has changed communication beyond recognition. *So central has it become to daily life that many users feel anxious without it.* Whether this dependence is acceptable is now a question every school must answer.

Part 3: Practice sets

Rewrite each simple sentence using the pattern given in the prompt. The sentences are all about technology and communication, so keep the register formal.

Example Set 1 (Pattern 1 – Not only ... but also ...)

Simple sentence:	The online platform saves paper, and it gives students instant feedback.
Prompt:	<i>Begin with 'Not only' to add a second advantage.</i>
Teacher's Answer:	Not only does the online platform save paper, but it also gives students instant feedback.

Example Set 2 (Pattern 1 – Not only ... but also ...)

Simple sentence:	E-books are cheaper than printed textbooks, and they are far lighter to carry.
Prompt:	<i>Use 'Not only ... but also ...' to combine the two advantages of e-books.</i>
Teacher's Answer:	Not only are e-books cheaper than printed textbooks, but they are also far lighter to carry.

Example Set 3 (Pattern 2 – Only + adverbial)

Simple sentence:	Students can concentrate on their revision once they put their phones away.
Prompt:	<i>Begin with 'Only when'.</i>
Teacher's Answer:	Only when they put their phones away can students concentrate on their revision.

Example Set 4 (Pattern 2 – Only + adverbial)

Simple sentence:	Schools can protect students' privacy by issuing clear guidelines on social media use.
Prompt:	<i>Begin with 'Only by'.</i>
Teacher's Answer:	Only by issuing clear guidelines on social media use can schools protect students' privacy.

Example Set 5 (Pattern 3 – Never / Rarely / Seldom)

Simple sentence:	People rarely question the amount of time they spend scrolling on their phones.
Prompt:	<i>Begin with 'Rarely'.</i>

Teacher's Answer:	Rarely do people question the amount of time they spend scrolling on their phones.
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Example Set 6 (Pattern 3 – Never / Rarely / Seldom)

Simple sentence:	The workplace has never relied so heavily on technology.
Prompt:	<i>Begin with 'Never'.</i>
Teacher's Answer:	Never has the workplace relied so heavily on technology.

Example Set 7 (Pattern 4 – So ... that / Such ... that)

Simple sentence:	The problem of cyberbullying is so serious that every school must act.
Prompt:	<i>Begin with 'So serious'.</i>
Teacher's Answer:	So serious is the problem of cyberbullying that every school must act.

Example Set 8 (Pattern 4 – So ... that / Such ... that)

Simple sentence:	Online shopping is so popular that it has changed how we buy things.
Prompt:	<i>Begin with 'Such is the popularity of online shopping'.</i>
Teacher's Answer:	Such is the popularity of online shopping that it has changed how we buy things.

Part 4: Writing Task

Instructions:

The School Council is discussing whether smartphones should be banned during lessons. Write ONE paragraph (about 80–100 words) giving your view. Use at least two inversions and one relative clause.

I believe a total ban on smartphones would be a mistake. ***Not only do such devices help students look up information instantly, but they also allow them to organise revision with useful apps*** (inversion). ***Only when students are taught to use their phones responsibly can we expect them to develop self-discipline*** (inversion). ***So tempting is the screen, however, that pupils will still need guidance*** (inversion). A combination of education and clear rules, ***which respects both freedom and responsibility*** (relative clause), would serve the school far better than a simple ban.